



Air India Retrofitted Boeing 787 Dreamliner

The newest addition to Air India's fleet is its retrofitted Boeing 787 Dreamliners. These are essentially the older Dreamliners, which are undergoing a complete transformation with brand new cabin interiors and layout, corresponding to the new Boeing 787-9 aircraft launched by the airline a few months earlier. At the pointy nose of the Dreamliner, Air India fits 20 business class 'suites', with sliding privacy doors, a tasteful pastel colour scheme, a 17-inch 4K touchscreen and a seat that extends to a beautiful flat bed. Other perks include ample storage for personal devices, a wireless charging mat built into the side console, multiple charging ports and a jaali inspired lamp over the passenger's shoulder, transforming the seat into a chic lounge of sorts.

This cabin is going to be the Air India standard for the next few years and hence is particularly relevant for the Indian passenger.

New first class lounge on the block

We have always maintained that Cathay Pacific curates some of the best airport lounge experiences in the world and their new The Wing, First, at Hong Kong International Airport is the latest in their ultra-luxe lounge offering. Cathay Pacific has partnered with London-based design firm Studiolise to create a chic space for the airline's well-heeled first class guests. Walnut wood, onyx accents and granite flooring, are ubiquitous throughout the lounge, which features multiple private relaxation areas. The Bureau is a private office space, of sorts, where business travellers can conduct small meetings, à la carte fine dining meals are available at The Dining Room with full table service, and a dedicated wellness space, The Retreat, with relaxation pods, massages on offer and, finally, a natural-light filled Atrium, with a self-service gourmet pantry.

Air India's new Dreamliner cabins (Left); Singapore Airlines' culinary refresh (Below); The new ultr-luxe lounge offering from Cathay Pacific

Emirates Airbus A380 Retrofitted

An ever-familiar favourite in the skies, Emirates A380s are being completely transformed. The world's largest aircraft operating for the Dubai-based carrier is going more premium heavy, adding 76 business class seats to its cabin, up from 58. The business class seats get a refresh, with an elegant pastel finish and wooden-finish trims, quilted leather seats that extend to a full flatbed mode, and aisle access for all passengers. The oversized touchscreen is an Emirates signature. The prime offering is the onboard lounge, with a refreshed, almost private jet-like design, where guests can enjoy cocktails and conversations with fellow passengers on a long haul flight.

Elevated gastronomy on Singapore Airlines

The world's most awarded airline, stands out with its exceptional first and business class hard product. That said, the inflight dining experience of Singapore Airlines just got a major refresh with the introduction of over 100 new dishes in the SIA Chef's Selection menu. Passengers across all classes will see an elevated menu design, new presentation and a focus on seasonal ingredients. Suites and First Class passengers will enjoy select dishes that can be customised and pre-ordered at the time of booking.

The airline also has dedicated Air Sommeliers on board, specially trained to present, decide and serve the right wine pairing with these dishes. The wine selection in First and Business class also sees the addition of many new variants.

What's more, the airline has also introduced new crockery, created in collaboration with Christofle, the French luxury tableware house, featuring the iconic batik motif that is also seen on the uniforms of its flight attendants.

This gastronomic refresh is part of Singapore Airlines' new luxury travel curation, to be announced in its entirety in November 2026, where we predict a range of new cabin products as well.

Etihad Airbus A321LR

This aircraft from Abu Dhabi-based Etihad Airways is the talk of town as it is a narrow body with the luxe layout of a wide body aircraft. This is essentially a single aisle aircraft, with two first class suites at the very front, followed by 14 reverse herringbone seats that go into a fully flatbed mode. Starting with the first class suites, in a 1-1 layout, with a sliding privacy door, a 20-inch touchscreen, allowing you to connect your Bluetooth headphones, wireless charging and multiple charging ports. The business class of this aircraft features seven rows in a 1-1 layout, 17.3 inch touchscreen, cocktail table, wireless charging and is designed in such a way that the passenger faces away from the aisle, increasing privacy.

Riyadh Air Boeing 787-9 Dreamliner

The new luxe airline of the Middle East, Saudi Arabia-based Riyadh air impresses with its slick branding and ultra-sleek cabin revelations. Interesting to note that on their spanking new Boeing 787-9 Dreamliner aircraft, the airline divides its business class product into two segments— the first row of the business class cabin features four Business Elite suites for an ultra-private, elevated experience. The two central suites can be converted into one larger double bed, 32-inch 4K screens, ultra-high privacy screens that enclose the suites. The second row onwards, within this cabin, standard business class operates, with plush amenities such as wireless charging, high-speed Internet (across the aircraft). The business cabin features an audio system by Devialet, embedded into the headrest, for an immersive inflight entertainment experience.